

Useful Phrases and Vocabulary for E-mail

Title

When you don't know the name:

- Dear Sir or Madam,
- Dear Director/Editor/Manager/...
- Hello,

When you know the name:

- Dear Mr, Mrs, Ms ...
- Dear John, / Hello Pat, / Hi Mary, / Hey John,

When writing to a group:

- Dear all, / Dear Members of ...
- Hi everyone,

Opening Statement

General

- I hope this message finds you well.
- I hope everything is alright with you.
- I am writing to you regarding a recent matter.
- I hope you are having a good day.
- I am writing to follow up on a previous issue.
- I would like to bring something to your attention.
- I am writing to ask for some information.
- I hope this email reaches you at a convenient time.
- I hope you are doing well.

Replying to an email:

- Thanks (very much) for your email.
- This is to thank you for your email.

Giving a reason:

- I'm just writing to ...
 - Just a (quick) note to ...
 - Just a short email to ...
 - I wanted to ...
 - I would like to ...
- clarify ...
 - confirm ...
 - inform you ...
 - follow up on ...
 - let you know ...
 - reply to ...
 - request ...
 - tell you ...
 - thank you ...
 - update you ...

Body of the Email

Making Requests

- I am interested in receiving/finding out ..
- I would like to receive ...
- I would be grateful if ...
- Could/Can you please send me ... ?
- Would you be able to (help) ... ?
- I'd appreciate a reply asap.

Informing

- I'd like to inform you of ...
- I'm writing to tell you about .../let you know ...
- Just to update you on ...
- FYI: This is to let you know ...
- Hope this helps.
- Let me know if you need anything else.

Requesting action

- Could you please let me know ... ?

- Have you ... yet?
- Can you send ... to me, please?
- Please get/keep in touch.
- Keep me posted.

Making arrangements

- I'm writing to set up/arrange ...
- How/What about Tuesday?

Confirming arrangements

- I'd like to confirm ...
- Looking forward to seeing/meeting you on ...

Changing arrangements

- This is to let you now that I've had to put off/postpone ...
- I'm writing to call off/cancel ...
- I'm afraid I can't make/manage Friday. How about ... instead?

Giving good news

- I am pleased to inform you ...
- I'm happy to tell you ...
- You'll be happy/delighted to hear that ...

Giving bad news

- I regret to tell/inform you ...
- I'm sorry, but ...
- I am afraid that ...
- Unfortunately, ...

Complaining

- I'm writing to complain (about ...).
- We're not happy with ...

- I was disappointed to find/hear ...
- I'm afraid that ...
- Unfortunately, ...

Apologizing

- I'm afraid I can't help you.
- I must apologize for ...
- I deeply regret ...
- I apologize for any inconvenience caused.
- Please accept my apologies.
- I'm so sorry ...

Friendly Closing Statement

- I look forward/looking forward to hearing from you/to your reply.
- Hope to hear from you soon.
- I'd appreciate a reply asap.

Offering more help:

- Do not hesitate to contact me if you need any
- Feel free to get in touch ...
 - if you have any other questions
 - if you need more help.
 - with any questions.
- Let me know if you need anything else/if I can help you further.

General:

- Thank you for your help/cooperation/time.
- Hope all is well with you.
- Have a nice day/weekend!

Signing Off

Formal

- Yours sincerely,
- Yours faithfully,

Neutral / Polite

- Kind regards,
- Best regards, (This one is always the best option.)
- Regards,

Friendly

- Best wishes,
- Warm regards,
- Many thanks,

Don't forget to write your name at the end.

Useful Verbs

Example

- | | |
|-------------------|---|
| • to apologize | • I'd like to apologize for any inconvenience caused. |
| • to appreciate | • I'd appreciate it if you could send me . |
| • to arrange | • I'm writing to arrange a meeting ... |
| • to ask (if) | • This is to ask if you could ... |
| • to assist | • Please let us know if I can assist you in any way. |
| • to clarify | • I am writing to clarify the terms of the agreement. |
| • to complain | • I'm writing to complain about |
| • to confirm | • I'd like to confirm my booking/the date of our next meeting. |
| • to contact | • Please contact me at your earliest convenience. |
| • to enquire | • I'd like to enquire about ... |
| • to follow up | • Just wanted to follow up on my application. |
| • to get in touch | • Please get in touch (with me) asap. |
| • to inform | • This is to inform you that .../inform you of a problem. |
| • to let sb know | • Can you let me know the price of ...? |
| • to postpone | • I'm afraid I've had to postpone the meeting. |
| • to put off | • I'm going to have to put off the meeting till next week. |
| • to receive | • I've just received the invitation ... |
| • to regret | • I regret to inform you that ... |
| • to reply | • I am writing to reply to your enquiry about ... |
| • to sort out | • Please sort out the mess with the dates! |
| • to touch base | • I just wanted to touch base with you before the meeting. |
| • to update | • This is to update you on the process of |